



# Managing Engagement for Outcomes

Week 6 • Day 2 • Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

TPM Academy



## Day 2 Objectives

- Apply the **4 engagement principles**: early, deliberate, match-form-to-power, bidirectional
- Pick **cadence + format + length** per quadrant
- Build "right now" asks across **decisions / information / action** — decision asks trace to a RACI matrix (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed)
- Diagnose your **engagement anti-patterns** and design counter-measures
- Identify the **5 most consequential asks** for Friday's negotiation



# Today's Shape

| Clock         | Block                       | Outcome                                   |
|---------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 09:00 – 09:15 | Opening                     | Pin SEP Section 1 grid + RACI on the wall |
| 09:15 – 10:30 | Block 1 + Activity 1        | Engagement style calibration              |
| 10:45 – 12:00 | Block 2 + Activity 2        | Recurring engagement plan                 |
| 13:00 – 14:15 | Block 3 + Activity 3        | "Right now" asks                          |
| 14:30 – 16:00 | Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap | Anti-patterns + AI cross-check            |

# Block 1 — Engagement Principles

Four rules + style by quadrant

# The 4 Engagement Principles

| Principle           | Plain English                                                             |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Engage early        | Surprise = anger. Surface concerns before decisions.                      |
| Engage deliberately | One channel per stakeholder.                                              |
| Match form to power | High-power gets crisp writing; high-interest gets conversation.           |
| Bidirectional asks  | Every engagement names what they need from us AND what we need from them. |

**(3) and (4) are the differentiators.** Most TPMs do (1) and (2) by quarter 2 in role.



# Style by Quadrant

HP = High Power, HI = High Interest, LP = Low Power, LI = Low Interest (from the Power × Interest grid).

| Quadrant | Cadence            | Format                     | Length                 |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------|------------------------|
| HP × HI  | Weekly / bi-weekly | Brief + 30-min sync        | 1 page; focused agenda |
| HP × LI  | Monthly / trigger  | Crisp written              | < 250 words            |
| LP × HI  | Bi-weekly          | Email digest; group thread | 5 bullets              |
| LP × LI  | Quarterly / launch | Newsletter                 | Short                  |

**Starting points.** Adjust per stakeholder personality.

# Activity 1 — Engagement Calibration

Quads • 45 minutes

8 stakeholder profiles. Place on grid; pick cadence/format/length.

- 10 min: place all 8 on the grid
- 25 min: pick cadence + format + length
- 10 min: disagree on 1–2; document why



10 + 25 + 10

# Block 2 — Recurring Engagement Plan

Per stakeholder: cadence, format, channel, asks





# Engagement Plan Template

```
### <Name / Role>
**Quadrant:** ...

**Cadence:** weekly / bi-weekly / monthly / trigger
**Format:** memo / email / sync / standup mention
**Length:** < N words / < N min

**What they need from us (recurring):** ...
**What we need from them (recurring):** ...

**What they need from us right now:** ...
**What we need from them right now:** ...

**Channel of choice:** email / Slack / sync / Confluence
**Backup channel:** ...

**Stakeholder-specific notes:** ...
```

# Time Allocation Sanity Check

- **Most time** → high-power × high-interest
- **Crispest writing** → high-power × low-interest
- **Group channels** → low-power × high-interest
- **Light touch** → low-power × low-interest

**Most rookie TPMs over-invest in low-power × high-interest.** They're easy to engage; they ask for time.

## Activity 2 — Recurring Plan

Quads • 50 minutes

- 5 min: sort by quadrant
- 20 min: HP × HI detailed plans
- 10 min: HP × LI crisp plans
- 5 min: LP × HI group plans
- 5 min: LP × LI lightweight plans
- 5 min: time allocation sanity check



5 + 20 + 10 + 5 + 5 + 5

# Block 3 — "Right Now" Asks

Decisions / Information / Action — both directions

# The 3 Asks Categories

| Category    | Examples                                                     |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Decisions   | Confirm scope; sign off on architecture; approve SLO targets |
| Information | Answer a question; share a doc; introduce someone            |
| Action      | Add a story to backlog; schedule a review; make a call       |

**Reciprocal asks:** what will *they* ask of *you*? Predict; don't be surprised — ask for an SLO (Service Level Objective) sign-off and expect a scope ask back.



# Conflict Surfacing

Are any asks across stakeholders **in tension with each other**?

- Asking architect to defer + asking eng director to approve launch date
- Asking security for a fast review + asking compliance for a thorough audit
- Asking CS for customer feedback + asking sales not to surface it yet

**Surfacing conflict early** is the senior-author signal. Buried conflict ships as escalation.

# Activity 3 — "Right Now" Asks

Quads • 50 minutes

- 30 min: 3–5 asks per stakeholder (mix of categories)
- 10 min: predict reciprocal asks
- 5 min: flag conflicts
- 5 min: pick the 5 most consequential



30 + 10 + 5 + 5

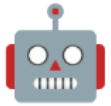
# Block 4 — Anti-Patterns + AI Cross-Check

Diagnose tendencies; design counter-measures



# The 6 Engagement Anti-Patterns

| Anti-pattern    | Counter-measure                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Channel sprawl  | One channel of record per stakeholder      |
| Rolling silence | Calendar each cadence as recurring         |
| Surprise reveal | Engage early; pre-share                    |
| Asymmetric asks | Build "what we offer" into each engagement |
| Veto avoidance  | Trigger-based engagement from watch list   |
| Email avalanche | Match length to audience                   |



# AI Cross-Check

Role: Senior PM reviewing a junior TPM's engagement plan.  
Context: <SEP Section 1 + Section 2 stakeholder list and engagement plans>  
Task: Identify the top 3 engagement risks:  
1. A stakeholder likely under-served by the plan  
2. A stakeholder likely over-served (TPM wasting attention)  
3. A specific anti-pattern the plan is exposed to  
Constraints:  
- Be specific  
- Suggest a concrete adjustment  
Format: 3 findings – Risk / Why / Adjustment.

# Activity 4 — Anti-Patterns + AI

Quads • 55 minutes • Wrap

- 10 min: score self on 6 anti-patterns (H/M/L)
- 25 min: design counter-measures for top 2–3
- 15 min: document in Section 2
- 5 min: AI prompt + provenance



10 + 25 + 15 + 5 • 15-min wrap



# Day 2 Wrap

## What we built

- Recurring engagement plan per stakeholder
- "Right now" asks (decisions/info/action)
- Reciprocal asks predicted
- 5 most consequential asks for Friday
- Anti-pattern counter-measures
- Stakeholder Engagement Plan (SEP) Section 2 drafted

## What opens tomorrow

- **Communicating technical trade-offs**
- One-page brief for non-technical execs
- Translation layer: Technical Concept Document (TCD)/Technical Modeling Document (TMD) trade-offs → business

**Bring to Day 3:** SEP Sections 1–2 + your TCD Section 5 trade-offs. Tomorrow we translate one for an exec.

# Questions & Reflection

Which stakeholder will you stop hiding from after this week?